

devices have bigger batteries and these draw more power too. A tablet like an iPad will have a much bigger battery as compared to a smartphone like an iPhone. So, a bit of calculation on how much battery gets exhausted in how many hours will go a long way while choosing a portable charger.

Capacity or portability

If you choose a portable charger that is high on capacity, most likely it will not be available in an easily portable option. The bigger the capacity, chances are that the portable charger is heavier and not-so-portable. So, a monster-size charger may not fit in your bag so easily. Hence, it is advisable that you choose the right capacity instead of being greedy for a higher-capacity charger, if you want to keep it with yourself at all times.

Faster charging

You must have read about the chips that enable fast charging in a device. Some good chargers come fitted with simple integrated chips, or ICs, that ensure safe and speedy charging. These chips are smart enough to recognise the state of the device and then charge it accordingly.

When your device's battery is completely exhausted, you should not charge it with full-force. Instead, you should pre-charge it till a safe level. After that, you can opt for the fast-charging option. The speed of charging will depend on how advanced the chip used in the charger is. A good-quality chip will reduce the voltage when the device's battery has reached its full capacity,

eventually switching it off once the battery is fully-charged. Going for a portable charger fitted with one of these chips is a good idea.

Quality matters

What matters the most in a portable charger? Obviously, its battery! A charger is considered to be good when it has good-quality lithium-ion battery.

Experts believe that batteries from companies based in Japan are the best, including those from Panasonic and Sanyo, as these are built-to-last. Products from a good Korean company like Samsung are also considered good with respect to offering high-performance and value-for-money.

However, it is not easy to detect which cell is being used in the battery. Thus, one should do some research before investing in a charger.

Having said that, one should also remember that nothing lasts forever, and so is the case of a battery. A lithium-ion battery normally lasts for 500 cycle charges on an average. The battery's capacity gradually goes down, leading to shorter charge cycles.

The cable length

Although most chargers allow users to use charging cables of their own, checking the length of the cable is a great idea. Check if you are getting a short or reasonably-long cable with the charger.

Checking features like LED battery indicator can also prove to be useful, which is truly a welcome feature, particularly for those who tend to be forgetful. ●

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